



Amazon Assistant snooping?

Amazon Assistant lets you check prices at all sites you shop. Genuine effort or mere snooping? <https://digit.in/dec19-38>



Android TV Hindi Assistant

Support for Hindi and Vietnamese language for Google Assistant is now available for Android TV. <https://digit.in/dec19-39>

Xiaomi Redmi Note 8 Pro

Easy choice muddled with ads

The Redmi Note series has become ubiquitous to high performance and good cameras, all under ₹15,000. Xiaomi managed to pack in even more fire power and four cameras with the new Note 8 Pro without increasing the price of the entry variant. But with so many options now in the mid-range segment, where does the Redmi Note 8 Pro stand?

Design and display

The Note 8 Pro has a good grip owing to the curved corners. The width of the phone is also just enough to use it one-handed. We received the white colour variant for review and it looks quite premium and feels durable.

The Note 8 Pro also sports a large 6.53-inch display. The resolution and aspect ratio remains the same as the Note 7 Pro, while the waterdrop notch has been shrunk slightly. The welcome addition is HDR capability, although that only works in YouTube and games like PUBG Mobile.

Software

The Note 8 Pro runs on MIUI 10 based on Android 9 out of the box. A big addition is the Alexa integration. The Note 8 Pro is able to support two wake words. So Google Assistant and Alexa can both be used, although not simultaneously.

Then comes the question of ads in the UI. Yes, it's very much there but not quite in your face as before. The UI is riddled with apps and games that Xiaomi recommends you download. Thankfully you can turn off recommendations in Settings.

Performance

Among all the Note series launched by Xiaomi, the Note 8 Pro is unique in one way. It relies on a flagship MediaTek SoC instead of a Qualcomm mid-range processor. The base variant of the Note 8



Price
₹14,999



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Pro comes with 6GB RAM while the top-end has 8GB RAM. On benchmarks, the MediaTek G90T scores the highest in AnTuTu with 222904 in the mid-range segment. On Geekbench 5, the Note 8 Pro scores 352 and 1374 on single-core and multi-core CPU tests respectively.

The Helio G90T sports a Mali G76 MC4 GPU. On 3DMark Slingshot, the Note 8 Pro scored 2378, beaten only by the Realme X with 2690 points. The rest of the competition fail to match up to this score. In the real world, the Redmi Note 8 Pro works without a hitch. There's no lag whatsoever in the interface. Apps don't take much time to launch, especially the heavy ones like PUBG Mobile and Call of Duty: Mobile. The camera, however, takes a little longer to initialise.

Gaming on the Helio G90T is a charm. This is the reason why Xiaomi chose to go with this chipset. When it comes to temperatures, having put the phone through an hour long session of PUBG Mobile and Call of Duty: Mobile

each, we noted that the surface temperature never went beyond 45 degrees, with the transparent case on. The Note 8 Pro does run a little warmer than its immediate competition, but it's nothing that you should be concerned about.

The Note 8 Pro comes with a 4,500mAh battery but if you think that extends the battery life longer than the Redmi Note 7 Pro, you'll be left disappointed. It is about the same.

Camera

Photos from the 64MP primary lens look more or less similar to how photos from 48MP camera. The wide-angle lens works best during the day. The macro lens is a rarity in smartphones but I also found myself using that mode the least. The wide-angle lens of the Note 8 Pro covers a much larger area than the primary camera, but the colour reproduction is vastly different. The Night Mode is quite handy when shooting in low-light. The night mode produces vibrant photos in low-light.

Bottomline

The Xiaomi Redmi Note 8 Pro is an upgrade over the Note 7 Pro in almost every count. At least on paper. In the real world, there is a boost in gaming performance and display quality. The camera quality remains more or less the same despite a newer sensor. While gaming, the phone does run warmer than say the Realme 5 Pro, it doesn't go beyond 50 degrees, which is what we consider overheating in smartphones. The battery life of the phone is just as good as its predecessor, despite a larger battery. By the looks of it, Xiaomi took a bold step by choosing to go with a MediaTek flagship SoC and it seems to have paid off, making it quite a solid buy.

—Subhrojit Mallick

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.53-inch IPS LCD (1080x2340) | PROCESSOR: MediaTek Helio G90T | GPU: Mali-G76 MC4 | FRONT CAMERA: 20MP | REAR CAMERA: 64MP + 8MP + 2MP + 2MP | RAM: 6GB/8GB | STORAGE: 64GB/128GB | BATTERY CAPACITY: 4500mAh | OS: Android 9 Pie

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